INCH-POUND

A-A-54710
14 August 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, SPINAL ANESTHESIA, TUOHY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a 16 gage, 3 inch hypodermic needle suitable for use in the administration of spinal anesthesia.

Salient characteristics:

Material. The cannula and stylet shall be fabricated from Type 304 stainless steel in accordance with ASTM F899. The needle hub shall be fabricated from nickel-plated or chromium over nickel-plated brass in accordance with ASTM F1089. All materials shall meet the requirements for the boil test in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Style, design and dimensions. The assembly shall be a spinal needle, of the Tuohy design with a Huber point. The needle shall comply with Figure 1 as shown.

The needle hub shall have a female Luer lock fitting in accordance with ISO Standard 594.

Performance. The needle shall be designed for use at higher than normal pressures, as may be encountered in spinal surgery. Needles shall be tested for freedom from foreign matter, security of assembly, resistance to breakage, clear passage of fluid, leakage, elasticity, and stiffness.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Identification marking. The needle hub shall be permanently and legibly marked with the needle gage and contractor's name or registered trademark.

The stylet knob and needle shall be permanently and legibly marked with a corresponding serial number. There shall be no duplication of serial numbers delivered on any particular contract for items described in this specification. When it is necessary to use more than two characters for a serial number, then two or three alphabetical characters shall be used with the exception that the "O" and the "I" letters of the alphabet shall not be used.

Workmanship. Needles shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability. The cannula and stylet shall show a smooth finished outer surface free from pits and tool marks, and inner surface free from scale, deep pits, deep furrows, or die marks; the lumen of the cannula and the hub cavity shall be free from chips, dirt, or other foreign matter. Needles shall be sharp not blunt or bent, and points shall be free of feathered edges, burrs, or other defects, when examined under 7X power magnification.

Unit. Each (EA). One hypodermic needle, as specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one needle assembly

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests (dimensional), shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for test purposes shall be on needle assembly.

Freedom from foreign matter. The hub cavity shall be examined under 7X magnification, and good illumination, for chips and other foreign matter. In addition, a cotton swab tightly wrapped on the end of a small wooden applicator shall be vigorously turned down into the bottom of cavity, withdrawn and examined for chips and other foreign matter under 7X magnification and good illumination. The cannula shall be tested for blockage by inserting a wire (or stylet) through the lumen of the cannula.

Security of assembly. An axial load of 20 pounds shall be applied between the cannula and hub, and between the stylet wire and stylet knob for a period of three (3) minutes. Any separation shall be cause for failure.

Resistance to breakage. The needle hub shall be held in a fixed position, and a force shall be applied to the cannula, at a distance from the hub of 1-1/4 inches, in order to bend the cannula in a clockwise direction through an arc of 20° from the original or neutral position. The operation shall then be reversed (i.e., bent through an arc of 20° from the neutral position in a counter-clockwise direction), and finally, the cannula shall be returned to the neutral position. This complete operation (or cycle) shall be repeated 20 times. Any breakage shall be cause for failure.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Clear passage of fluid. The fluid path shall be tested using water or another suitable test fluid. Test fluid shall be applied to the fluid path at a pressure of 3-1/2 ± 1/2 psig and shall pass freely through within three (3) seconds of application utilizing the gages specified in ISO Standard 594.

Leakage. With the needle in a horizontal position, the hub shall be attached to a water pressure source having a pressure gage. The water shall be permitted to run through the needle so as to fill the hub cavity space and the lumen of the cannula. The lumen shall then be sealed by a piece of solid rubber pressed on to the point. A pressure of 45 psi shall be applied for 30 minutes. The test fixture shall be in accordance with ISO Standard 594. Any leakage shall be a test failure.

Elasticity. The needle hub shall be held in a fixed position, and a sufficient force shall be applied to the cannula, at a distance of 1-1/4 inches from the hub, to bend the cannula to one side through an arc of 9° from the original or neutral position. The force shall then be released and the point to where the cannula returns shall be noted. Any deformation shall be a test failure.

Stiffness. The cannula shall be placed across two test edges (0.002 inch radius maximum) separated by a distance of 1.000 ± 0.003 inch. A load of 80 ± 1/4 ounces shall be applied at the center of the span and the resulting maximum deflection of the cannula shall be measured using gage graduations of at least 0.001 inch. The force shall be applied through an edge with a maximum radius of 0.036 inch, and centered to within ± 0.003 inch. Deflection of greater than .008 inch shall be cause for failure.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwis otherwise provided for under the provisions of the con

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE 1: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification
6515-00-302-5250	NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, SPINAL ANESTHESIA, Tuohy, 16 gage, 3 inch.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTE 2: Copies of ISO Standards 594/1 and 594-2 may be obtained through the American National Standards Institute (ANSI), 11 West 42nd Street, New York, NY 10036.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

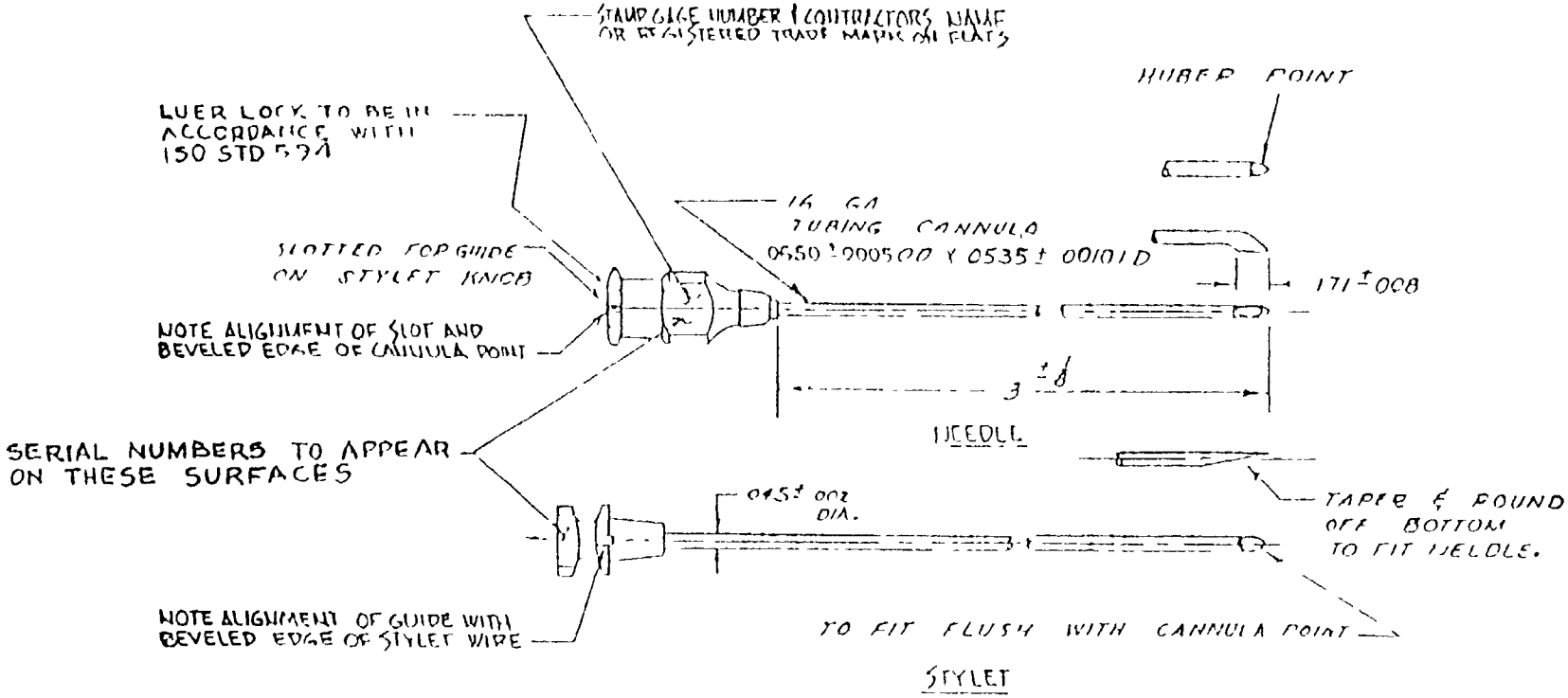
DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-5427

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES

A-A-54710

NSN 6515-00-302-5250

FIGURE 1 NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, SPINAL ANESTHESIA, TUOHY

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-02-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54710	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 14 August 1992

3 DOCUMENT TITLE NEEDLE, HYPODERMIC, SPINAL ANESTHESIA, TUOHY

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	e. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

7. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 *Previous editions are obsolete* 198/

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:37Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.